



February 11, 2025

2025 Annual Enrollment Trend Report Executive Summary

Background

In April 2022, the Board created the Long Range Advisory Committee (LRAC) to involve the community in guiding the district's response to enrollment decline. In June 2023, the committee provided the Board with a [final report of recommendations](#). The recommendations included a process and metrics for when the Board should take action related to the enrollment at a particular school. In addition, the committee recommended that the Board should receive an annual enrollment trend report from staff regarding school utilization which would also include the number of classes per grade level and five-year enrollment projections by school. This is the second Annual Trend Report

Annual Enrollment Trend Report

Based on the metrics and data presented in the report, particular schools may be identified for either the Enrollment Advisory Phase or the Community Engagement Phase:

ENROLLMENT ADVISORY PHASE

If an elementary school has **2 or fewer classes per grade level on average** and enrollment is **60% of capacity or below**, the Board and community should be aware:

- Resource allocation will adhere to the established staffing funding formula to the greatest extent possible.
- Multi-age classrooms may be necessary to meet the funding formula.
- Library, counseling, and specials may be limited.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT PHASE

If an elementary school has **1.5 or fewer classes per grade level on average** and enrollment is **50% of capacity or below** with a projected trend to continue for at least 5 years, the Board will engage staff to lead a community-based process to develop possible solutions to provide a thriving, well-resourced educational environment for students and staff. Decision-making should be in the context of looking at geographic areas or multiple schools if appropriate. Timeline will be established by the Board.

This process may result in recommendations that could include but are not limited to:

- Continuing to operate at the established staffing funding formula
- Focus or specialized programming
- Reallocating grade levels with a neighboring school
- Closure/Consolidation

Enrollment and Capacity Projections

In December 2024, staff shared the updated annual enrollment data and an analysis of trends. The Annual Enrollment Trend Report further evaluates this data in terms of each school's capacity; what the enrollment count will look like in terms of the number of classes at each grade level for each school; and 5-year projections for these data points. The report also identifies what these numbers mean for schools in terms of the LRAC enrollment metrics.

For the 2024-25 school year, there are eight schools that are in the Enrollment Advisory Phase (Coal Creek, Community Montessori, Eisenhower, Eldorado K-5, Flatirons, Kohl, Mesa, and Whittier) meaning that they are ≤ 2.0 rounds and $\leq 60\%$ capacity. No schools entered the Community Engagement Phase (≤ 1.5 classes per grade and $\leq 50\%$ capacity) this year.

Heatherwood Elementary initiated the Community Engagement Process in the 2023-24 school year and will continue to be monitored under that designation for several years. Through the Community Engagement Process, Heatherwood decided to develop a new environmental STEAM programmatic focus, which will launch in the 2025-26 school year. Heatherwood's enrollment did increase slightly this year.

Projections indicate that in the next five years, elementary level enrollment will continue to decline approximately 1% per year, throughout the district, and by 2029-30, BVSD will have eight schools in the Enrollment Advisory Phase and three in the Community Engagement Phase. These schools are distributed with seven in Boulder, one in Louisville, one in Superior, and two in Broomfield. These projections show some improvement from the previous projections, with two fewer schools identified overall and three fewer projected to be in the Community Engagement Phase.